ESSENCE HARVESTING & THE CAMP FORGE

Agreed reward system and three starting enemy concepts | Prototype reference | 2 November 2026

This document records decisions from our reward-system discussion. Creature names remain placeholders, and all three prototypes use regular harvesting. Where values or interactions were not finalized, they are identified as provisional or pending.

1 | Essence harvesting

• Each enemy type has its own distinct Essence. Each individual successfully harvested enemy yields 1 Essence, including multiple copies of that enemy in the same fight and repeat encounters.

• Regular harvest: Some enemies, including all three prototypes below, have no special harvesting condition.

• Conditional harvest: Other enemies have a printed requirement that must be satisfied at the moment they die. An earlier achievement of the condition is insufficient if it no longer holds at death.

• Most normal-enemy harvesting requirements are visible. Elite and Boss requirements are initially hidden and are permanently revealed after the first defeat. For visible requirements, current eligibility is public; hidden eligibility is not disclosed.

• On an eligible enemy death, place 1 Essence token on its defeated enemy card, not on the grid. Following a victory, add all earned tokens to the party inventory. On defeat, discard all tokens from that encounter.

• All acquired Essence is shared by the party and safe once banked. Previously collected Essence cannot be lost through defeat, curses, enemies, or events; it is consumed only when voluntarily spent.

2 | Enemy discovery and repeat encounters

• Normal enemies generally show their reward types and Essence costs immediately. Elites and Bosses reveal their reward lists after their first defeat. Exceptions may be printed per enemy.

• A reward might be labeled "Attack Face - 2 Essence" or "Body - 6 Essence". Its exact effect stays hidden until crafted.

• Elites can be encountered again. Some Bosses are repeatable; others are unique. Defeating a unique Boss unlocks a special later opportunity to obtain its Essence, with details specific to that Boss.

• Campaign encounters can repeat enemy types. Optional Hunts can target previously encountered enemies and unlock through events, Boss victories, or milestones. Hunt frequency and persistence are outside this reward-system draft.

3 | Camp Forge: spending and ownership

• After encounters, the party returns to Camp. During refitting, the Forge consumes shared, enemy-specific Essence to unlock rewards. All reward entries are independently unlockable; none excludes another.

• Die faces: Spending the listed cost permanently unlocks the design, reveals its text, and grants the first physical copy. Every additional copy costs the same Essence amount as the initial unlock. Copies can be made immediately in the same Camp visit; there is no owned-copy maximum.

• Other rewards: Weapons, Bodies, Memories and Souls are one-time permanent unlocks, not repeat-copy purchases.

• All acquired faces, Weapons, Bodies and Memories are held in a shared party collection and may be exchanged during refitting under the normal construction rules. Souls are bound to their recipient hero and cannot be traded; that hero may own and swap between multiple Souls.

• Soul recipients are specified by the reward source: an Event can assign a Soul to one hero; for Boss Soul unlocks the party can choose unless otherwise stated. The existing tutorial Boss specifically awards a Soul to each hero.

• Crafted faces remain owned permanently and may be kept unequipped. No dismantling or Essence refunds. Explicit curse/face-change effects still follow their own rules.

4 | Forge services

• The Forge initially provides ordinary reward crafting. Additional services unlock through Bosses, Events and Campaign Milestones.

• Services have different fixed costs depending on service type, may be used without a usage cap once unlocked, and use existing Essence rather than a new currency.

• For one service payment, the full cost must consist of one enemy Essence type; any type is eligible. Example: 3 Hollow Knight Essence is valid for a 3-Essence service; 2 Hollow Knight + 1 Witch Essence is invalid.

Potential service	Illustrative cost	Status
Cleansing	3 Essence	Candidate, not finalized
Reforging	4 Essence	Candidate, not finalized
Restoration	5 Essence	Candidate, not finalized

Other services mentioned as possibilities: Transmutation and temporary Empowerment. Exact service effects, final prices, and unlock milestones are still undecided.

5 | Reward pricing principle

Reward costs are individually balanced using power, enemy encounter frequency, difficulty of harvesting, and reward category. There is no universal price schedule. The Essence costs in the creature tables below are the values selected for these prototypes, with the Movement and Support face costs originally proposed as provisional values.

THREE PROTOTYPE ENEMIES

All three are ordinary enemies, grant 1 Essence per successful harvest, and require no special harvest condition. Names are working labels only.

Enemy 1 | Bone Creature

Identity: bone-based synergy across Attack, Defense, and Skill results. No separate spendable Bone resource or Bone-consumption engine is part of this simplified prototype.

Reward	Category / Trait	Effect	Cost
Bone Growth	Skill / Bone	Gain 1 Block and Move 1.	1
Bone Strike	Attack / Bone	Deal 1 damage per Bone face rolled this turn.	2
Bone Guard	Defense / Bone	Gain 1 Block per Bone face rolled this turn.	3

Bone trait: All three faces count as Bone, including themselves. Count Bone results from this turn even if those results have already resolved (working interpretation chosen in the discussion). The Bone Strike and Bone Guard results therefore each count as at least one Bone if rolled.

Example: Bone Growth, Bone Strike, and Bone Guard rolled together means Bone Strike deals 3 damage and Bone Guard provides 3 Block. These are reward faces, not yet detailed enemy AI actions.

Enemy 2 | Support Creature

Identity: a weak support-oriented enemy, with one healing, one self-sacrifice buffing, and one copy/manipulation face, plus a rarer Memory.

Reward	Category	Effect	Cost
Shared Remedy	Skill / Healing	Heal yourself for 1 HP. If at least 1 HP was actually restored, choose one ally within Range 2 and heal them for 1 HP.	1
Sorrow's Offering	Skill	You may lose 1 HP. If you do, choose one ally within Range 2: they gain either 2 Block or +1 damage on their next Attack. If declined, spend the face without effect.	2
Shared Burden	Skill / Copy	Choose one of your other Action Die results rolled this round (already resolved or unresolved). An ally within Range 2 may spend one unresolved Action Die result to resolve a copy of that ability instead. No physical faces change. Cannot copy Shared Burden itself.	3
Memory of Loss	Memory / Passive	Abilities with Healing keyword gain +1 range, except abilities specifying Self or Adjacent. The first time you heal yourself each combat, restore 1 additional HP.	4

Shared Burden: Copied text uses the copied ability's usual restrictions, targeting and costs. No replacement of installed die faces takes place. The detailed inter-unit timing for an ally using the copy remains a playtest clarification.

Memory of Loss: It may improve the ally-targeting range of Shared Remedy from 2 to 3, and may increase its first self-heal by 1. The Healing keyword needs formal standardization in the master rules; its intended use here is recorded.

Enemy 3 | Movement Creature

Identity: repositioning and attack timing, rewarding a hero who moves before attacking.

Reward	Category	Effect	Cost
Retreat	Movement	Move up to 2 spaces. If you finish farther from every enemy than where you started, gain 1 Block.	1
Momentum Strike	Attack	If you moved at least 2 spaces this turn, deal 1 damage to an adjacent enemy. If you moved at least 3 spaces this turn, deal [Numeric +1] damage instead.	2
Evasive Counter	Defense / Reaction	When targeted by an Attack, gain 1 Block before the Attack resolves. If you take no damage from that Attack, Move 1.	3

Existing rule interaction: Damage taken means actual HP lost. Thus Evasive Counter allows its Move 1 if the incoming Attack is completely absorbed by Block. Movement only occurs after that Attack resolves.

6 | Playtest checkpoints / not yet established

• Determine enemy combat statistics, enemy dice, action distributions, and encounter composition separately; this document defines their reward profiles, not their AI.

• Confirm timing/eligibility for Shared Burden in the shared-roll system, especially if the ally has already activated this round.

• Standardize the Healing keyword and check how the Memory of Loss range rule should apply to unusual targeting wording.

• Playtest same-cost face duplicates and Bone-result scaling; current owned-copy limits are intentionally unrestricted.

• Set exact Forge service effects, their unlocks, and Boss-specific special harvest events in their respective design areas.